

EQ Self-Assessment

FREE RESOURCE · EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

EQ Self-Assessment

A 20-question emotional intelligence self-assessment covering self-awareness, self-regulation, motivation, empathy, and social skills — the Goleman model. Includes a scoring guide and development priority identification.

20 Questions

5 Goleman Competencies

Scoring Guide

Development Planning

20

questions

5

competencies

100

max score

Development

guide

BEFORE YOU START

Rate yourself on how consistently you demonstrate each behaviour — not how you'd like to, or how you did once in an unusually good moment. Use a 1–5 scale: **1 = Rarely**, **3 = Sometimes**, **5 = Consistently**. Answer all 20 questions honestly before moving to the scoring guide; emotional intelligence assessed this way is only useful if the self-rating is accurate.

THE GOLEMAN MODEL

Psychologist Daniel Goleman's model of emotional intelligence organises EQ into five competencies: Self-Awareness and Self-Regulation (how you manage yourself), Motivation (what drives you), and Empathy and Social Skills (how you manage relationships with others).

Self-Awareness

4 questions

Recognising your own emotions and understanding their effect on your thinking and behaviour

1**I can accurately name what I'm feeling in the moment, not just “good” or “bad.”**

1



2



3



4



5

Rarely / never

Consistently / always

2 I notice my emotional reactions before they affect my behaviour.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never Consistently / always

3 I understand how my moods affect my thinking and decision-making.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never Consistently / always

4 I know my own strengths and limitations realistically, without over- or under-estimating them.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never Consistently / always

Self-Regulation

4 questions

Managing disruptive emotions and impulses, and adapting to changing circumstances

5 I stay composed and think clearly even when I'm frustrated or under pressure.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never Consistently / always

6 I pause before reacting when something upsets me.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never Consistently / always

7 I adapt well to change rather than resisting it out of habit.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never Consistently / always

8 I take responsibility for my mistakes rather than deflecting blame.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never Consistently / always

Motivation

4 questions

Being driven to pursue goals for reasons beyond external reward, status, or money

9 I stay committed to goals even when progress is slow or setbacks occur.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never

Consistently / always

10 I'm driven by more than external rewards like money, title, or recognition.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never

Consistently / always

11 I maintain optimism and keep going after a failure or disappointment.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never

Consistently / always

12 I hold myself to a high standard, independent of what others expect of me.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never

Consistently / always

Empathy

4 questions

Understanding other people's emotions, needs, and perspectives — and responding accordingly

13 I notice when someone is upset, even if they haven't said anything.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never

Consistently / always

14 I genuinely try to understand situations from other people's perspectives, not just my own.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never

Consistently / always

15 I adjust how I communicate based on what the other person needs, not just what's convenient for me.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never

Consistently / always

16 I'm attentive to how my words or actions land on others, before and while I speak.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never *Consistently / always*

Social Skills

4 questions

Managing relationships, building rapport, and working effectively with others

17 I can influence and persuade others without being manipulative or forceful.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never *Consistently / always*

18 I handle conflict or disagreement in a way that preserves the relationship.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never *Consistently / always*

19 I build genuine rapport with people across different backgrounds and communication styles.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never *Consistently / always*

20 I work effectively as part of a team, contributing to collective goals, not just my own.

☐ 1 ☐ 2 ☐ 3 ☐ 4 ☐ 5

Rarely / never *Consistently / always*

Scoring Guide

Add your scores for each competency, then combine them for an overall total out of 100.

Competency	Questions	Max Score	Your Score
Self-Awareness	4	$4 \times 5 = 20$	
Self-Regulation	4	$4 \times 5 = 20$	
Motivation	4	$4 \times 5 = 20$	
Empathy	4	$4 \times 5 = 20$	
Social Skills	4	$4 \times 5 = 20$	
Overall Total	20	100	

OVERALL SCORE INTERPRETATION

85–100

Highly Developed EQ

You show strong emotional intelligence across most or all of the five Goleman competencies. This is a genuine asset in leadership, collaboration, and difficult conversations.

Development focus: Keep it sharp — seek feedback periodically, since self-perception of EQ can drift out of step with how others actually experience you.

65–84

Solid, With Clear Growth Edges

You have real strength in most competencies, with one or two areas holding back your overall effectiveness.

Development focus: Identify your lowest-scoring competency and treat it as a specific, named development goal rather than a vague aspiration.

45–64

Developing — Uneven Across Competencies

Scores in this range often mean strength in one or two competencies (commonly self-awareness or motivation) alongside real gaps in others (often empathy or social skills).

Development focus: Look at the competency breakdown, not just the total — a single weak competency can undercut the value of the others.

20–44

Foundational Stage

This is a common starting point, and not a verdict on your character — emotional intelligence is a set of learnable skills, not a fixed trait.

Development focus: Start with self-awareness before anything else; every other competency depends on first noticing your own emotional state accurately.

READ THE COMPETENCIES, NOT JUST THE TOTAL

Two people can land on the same overall score for very different reasons. Someone strong in self-awareness and motivation but weak in empathy can come across as self-directed but difficult to work alongside. Look at your lowest-scoring competency specifically — it usually explains more than the total does.

Development Priority Identification

Scoring the assessment is the easy part. These prompts turn the results into something you'll actually act on.

Which competency scored lowest for you?

Name it specifically, and identify the single lowest-scoring question within it — that question usually points to the real, specific behaviour worth working on.

Describe a recent, real situation where this gap had a genuine cost.

A specific memory is far more useful for change than an abstract acknowledgement that "I could be better at this."

What is one specific, observable behaviour you could practise this week?

Not "be more empathetic" — something a colleague could actually notice, like "ask one follow-up question before responding in every 1:1 this week."

Who could give you honest feedback on this competency in a month?

Self-assessment alone has limits — emotional intelligence is often best measured by how others experience you, not how you experience yourself.

A NOTE ON GROWTH

Unlike IQ, emotional intelligence continues to develop throughout life with deliberate practice and honest feedback. Revisit this assessment every few months — not to chase a perfect score, but to notice whether your priority competency is actually shifting.